

Absolutely — **original** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “As for the cost, **the original** is obviously out of the question.”

Here **the original** means **the actual authentic Monet artwork itself, rather than a reproduction or copy**.

Word family: **original / originally / originality / origin / originate**

Base word: original

Parts of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Related forms: originally, originality, origin, originate

Your source sentence:

> “As for the cost, **the original** is obviously out of the question.”

Meaning in your passage: **the original = the authentic first artwork, not a copy — 原作；真跡**

Here **original** is functioning as a **noun**.

It means:

> **the actual artwork created by the artist, rather than a reproduction, copy, print, or imitation.**

繁體中文：

由藝術家本人創作的真正作品，而不是複製畫、印刷品或仿製品；原作 / 真跡

Natural translation:

> “The original is obviously out of the question.”

「Monet 的**原作 / 真跡**當然是不可能考慮的。」

So here:

> **the original = 原作本身**

This directly contrasts with the earlier:

> **reproduction = 複製畫 / 複製品**

1. **original = first / earliest version — 最初的；原來的**

The core adjective sense.

Practice 1

> “The building still has its **original** doors.”

「這棟建築仍保留著**原來的 / 最初的門**。」

Practice 2

> “The original plan was much simpler.”

「**原本的計劃**簡單得多。」

****original = 在後來改動、替換或發展之前最早存在的****

Common:

- * original plan
- * original version
- * original design
- * original name

2. **original = authentic, not copied — 原作的；原版的；真品的**

This is closely related to your source.

Practice 3

> “The museum owns the **original painting**.”

「博物館擁有那幅**原作 / 真跡**。」

Practice 4

> “Is this the original document or a copy?”

「這是**原件**還是副本？」

****original = 真正的原件，而不是複製、仿製或重製版本****

Natural Chinese depends on object:

- * artwork → 原作 / 真跡
- * document → 原件
- * recording → 原版
- * design → 原設計

3. **the original = original object/work itself — 原作；原件；原版**

This is your exact grammatical use.

Practice 5 — Original

> “The **original** is obviously out of the question.”

「那幅**原作**顯然是不可能考慮的。」

Practice 6

> “The reproduction is cheaper than the original.”

「複製品比**原作**便宜。」

the original = 被複製、修改或重新製作之前的那件真正原物 / 作品

4. **original = new and independently created — 原創的；有創意的**

A major distinct meaning.

Practice 7

> “She presented an **original idea**.”

「她提出了一個**原創 / 新穎的想法**。」

Practice 8

> “The design is simple but highly original.”

「這個設計雖然簡單，卻非常**有創意 / 具原創性**。」

original = 不是抄襲或照搬別人，而是由自己創造、具有新意的

This is one of the most important contrasts.

5. **original** = unusual / inventive — 新穎的；別出心裁的

A contextual branch of #4.

Practice 9

> “That is a very **original** solution.”

「那是一個非常**新穎 / 有創意的解決方法**。」

Practice 10

> “Her approach was original and effective.”

「她的方法既**別出心裁**又有效。」

original = 思路或做法不落俗套，具有獨特創意

I would merge this conceptually with “原創的”，rather than split it too aggressively.

6. **original** = belonging to the beginning / initial state — 原有的；最初狀態的

Practice 11

> “The room has been restored to its **original condition**.”

「房間已恢復到**原本的狀態**。」

Practice 12

> “The painting retained most of its original colour.”

「這幅畫保留了大部分**原有的色彩**。」

original = 某物一開始所具有的狀態、形式或特徵

7. **original** = first person/group responsible for something — 最早的；創始的

A useful historical/institutional extension.

Practice 13

> “She was one of the **original members** of the group.”

「她是這個團體的**創始成員之一**。」

Practice 14

> “The original owners sold the house years ago.”

「**最初的屋主**多年前已把房子出售。」

original = 最早參與、擁有、建立或使用某事物的

8. **original** = in the language/form first created — 原文的；原版的

A common publishing/media meaning.

Practice 15

> “I read the book in the **original English**.”

「我讀的是這本書的**英文原文**。」

Practice 16

> “The original recording was made in 1965.”

「**原版錄音**是在 1965 年錄製的。」

original = 作品最初創作、錄製或發表時所使用的語言 / 版本

9. **original** = noun, original work/version — 原作；原稿；原件

Broader noun use.

Practice 17

> “The gallery displayed both the copy and the **original**.”

「畫廊同時展示了複製品和**原作**。」

Practice 18

> “Please send us the original, not a photocopy.”

「請寄給我們**原件**，不要影印本。」

****an/the original = 被複製或改編所依據的原始作品 / 文件 / 物件****

10. ****an original = highly individual / unusual person — 很有個性的人；獨特的人****

A secondary informal noun meaning.

Practice 19

> “He was a true ****original****.”

「他真是一個非常****獨特、有自己風格的人****。」

Practice 20

> “She is one of those rare originals who never follows trends.”

「她是那種少見的、從不追隨潮流的****獨特人物****。」

****an original = 個性、思想或風格非常獨特、不像別人的人****

Register:

* informal/literary

* usually positive or admiring

11. ****originality = quality of being new/creative — 原創性；創意****

A major related noun.

Practice 21

> “The judges praised the ****originality**** of the design.”

「評審讚賞這個設計的****原創性 / 創意****。」

Practice 22

> “Her work lacks originality.”

「她的作品缺乏**原創性**。」

originality = 想法、作品或方法具有獨創性，不只是模仿別人

12. **originally** = at first — 原本；起初

A major related adverb.

Practice 23

> “The room was **originally** a library.”

「這個房間**原本**是一間圖書室。」

Practice 24

> “I originally planned to buy a smaller print.”

「我**最初**打算買一幅較小的印刷品。」

originally = 在事情開始時 / 最初的情況下

13. **originally** = in the first version/form — 最初地；原先以……形式

Practice 25

> “The novel was **originally** published in French.”

「這本小說**最初**以法文出版。」

Practice 26

> “The work was originally created for a private collection.”

「這件作品**最初**是為私人收藏而創作。」

originally = 某事物在最初創作、發表或形成時

Closely related to #12.

14. **origin = beginning/source — 起源；來源**

A major family extension.

Practice 27

> “The exact **origin** of the idea is unclear.”

「這個想法的確切**起源**並不清楚。」

Practice 28

> “The word is French in origin.”

「這個詞的**來源 / 語源**是法語。」

origin = 某事物開始、產生或來自的地方 / 時間 / 原因

15. **origin = family/geographical background — 出身；原籍；來源地**

A distinct contextual sense.

Practice 29

> “The artist was French by **origin**.”

「這位藝術家**原籍 / 出身**法國。」

Practice 30

> “The museum records the origin of each object.”

「博物館記錄每件物品的**來源地**。」

origin = 人、物或材料所來自的地方 / 背景

16. **originate = begin / come into existence — 起源；產生**

Practice 31

> “The style **originated** in France.”

「這種風格**起源於**法國。」

Practice 32

> “The idea originated in the nineteenth century.”

「這個想法**起源於**十九世紀。」

originate = 某事物最初開始、產生或出現

17. **originate** = create/initiate something — 創始；提出

A transitive/formal use.

Practice 33

> “The artist **originated** a new technique.”

「這位藝術家**創出了 / 創始了**一種新技法。」

Practice 34

> “The concept was originated by a small research team.”

「這個概念由一個小型研究團隊**最先提出**。」

originate — transitive = 成為某個想法、方法或做法的最初創造者

Register: formal and less common than the intransitive use.

Important distinction: **original** vs reproduction

Directly relevant to your passage.

original

= authentic artwork itself.

reproduction

= copied version of that artwork.

> Monet original

> = Monet 原作 / 真跡

> reproduction of Monet

> = Monet 畫作的複製品

So:

> **original ≠ reproduction**

Important distinction: **original vs copy**

original

= first/authentic item.

copy

= duplicate based on it.

> original document

> = 文件原件

> copy of the document

> = 文件副本

Important distinction: **original vs genuine**

original

emphasizes:

> first/authentic source object, not copied.

genuine

emphasizes:

> truly what it claims to be, not fake.

A painting can be:

> an original Monet

> = Monet 的原作

and also:

> a genuine Monet

> = 經認證確實是 Monet 的真跡

The emphasis differs.

Important distinction: **original vs authentic**

authentic

= genuine and correctly identified.

original

= the actual first work/object rather than a later copy.

For example:

> an authentic reproduction

is possible:

it could be an officially produced reproduction, but it is still **not the original**.

Important distinction: **original vs first**

first

= earliest in order/time.

original

= existing from the beginning, or serving as the source for later versions.

> first exhibition

> = 第一場展覽

> original version

> = 原始版本

Not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **original** vs **initial**

initial

= occurring at the beginning.

original

= first form before later change, often retained as a reference point.

> initial reaction

> = 最初反應

> original design

> = 原始設計

Initial often describes a stage; **original** often describes a source/version.

Important distinction: **original** vs **creative**

creative

= capable of producing imaginative ideas.

original

= genuinely new/not copied.

A person may be creative but produce an idea similar to something already existing.

So:

> creative = 有創意的

> original = 原創的 / 獨創的

Important distinction: **original vs unique**

original

= newly created/not copied.

unique

= only one of its kind / highly distinctive.

An idea can be original without being absolutely unique.

Important distinction: **original vs novel**

original

= independently created and not copied.

novel (adjective)

= new and unusual.

> original idea

> = 原創想法

> novel approach

> = 新穎方法

They overlap but emphasize different things.

Important distinction: **original — authentic vs creative**

This is the most important polysemy contrast.

Authentic/source:

> “the original painting”

= 原作

Creative:

> “an original painting”

can mean:

= 一幅原創畫作

Notice the article/context matters.

> **the original painting**

> usually = that authentic first painting

> **an original painting**

> often = an independently created artwork, not a reproduction

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: **original condition vs original idea**

original condition

= 最初 / 原有狀態

original idea

= 原創 / 有新意的想法

Same adjective, different sense.

Important distinction: **originally vs originally created**

originally

usually means:

> at first / in the beginning

> “It was originally blue.”

= 它原本是藍色。

It does ****not**** normally mean:

> “in a creative way.”

For “以原創方式” say:

> creatively / in an original way

Important distinction: ****origin vs original****

****origin****

noun:

= starting point/source

****original****

adjective/noun:

= first/authentic/newly created

> origin of the painting

> = 畫作的來源 / 起源

> original painting

> = 原作 / 原創畫作

Important distinction: ****originality vs authenticity****

****originality****

= degree of creativity/newness.

****authenticity****

= whether something is genuine/real.

A fake painting may imitate an original creative style but lack authenticity.

So:

> originality = 原創性

> authenticity = 真實性 / 真偽上的真實

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **original — first/earliest** = 最初的 / 原來的
- * **original — authentic** = 原作的 / 原件的 / 真品的
- * **the original** = 原作 / 原件 / 原版
- * **original — creative** = 原創的 / 有創意的
- * **original — inventive** = 新穎的 / 別出心裁的
- * **original — initial condition** = 原有的
- * **original — founding/first member** = 創始的 / 最早的
- * **original — first language/version** = 原文的 / 原版的
- * **an original** = 獨特、有個性的人
- * **originality** = 原創性 / 創意
- * **originally** = 原本 / 起初
- * **origin — source/beginning** = 起源 / 來源
- * **origin — background/place** = 出身 / 原籍 / 來源地
- * **originate — begin** = 起源 / 產生
- * **originate — create** = 創始 / 最先提出

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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original — first form	在後來改動、替換或發展之前最早存在的版本 / 形式
original — authentic	真正的原件 / 原作，而不是複製、仿製或重製版本
the original	被複製、改編或重製所依據的真正原作 / 原件
original — creative	不是抄襲或照搬，而是由自己創造並具有新意的
original — inventive	思路、設計或方法別出心裁、不落俗套的
original — condition	某物一開始具有的狀態、形式或特徵
original — founding	最早參與、建立、擁有或使用某事物的
original — language/version	作品最初創作、錄製或發表時的語言 / 版本
an original	個性、思想或風格非常獨特的人
originality	想法、作品或方法不模仿別人而具有的原創性
originally	在事情開始時；原本 / 起初
origin — source	某事物最初開始、產生或來自的來源
origin — background	人或物所來自的地點、族源或背景
originate	某事物最初開始、出現或產生
originate — transitive	最先創造、提出或建立某個想法 / 方法

For your original sentence

> “As for the cost, **the original** is obviously out of the question.”

The exact meaning is:

the original = Monet 親自創作的真正原畫，而不是印刷複製畫或其他 reproduction

Natural translation:

> **「至於價錢，Monet 的原作當然完全不在考慮範圍內。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **the original painting** → 那幅真正原作
- > **original condition** → 原本狀態
- > **original plan** → 原來的計劃
- > **original idea** → 原創 / 新穎想法
- > **original member** → 創始 / 最早成員
- > **original language** → 原文語言
- > **originality** → 原創性
- > **originally** → 原本 / 起初
- > **origin** → 起源 / 來源
- > **originate** → 起源 / 產生
- > **original vs reproduction** → 原作 vs 複製品